

Class of COVID-era babies to test schools

A return to normal or more delayed learning?

By Christopher Huffaker
GLOBE STAFF

Molly Schneider's son Asa was born in July 2020, in the depths of COVID precautions in Massachusetts. Schneider and her husband were self-described "anxious lunatic parents" wiping down everything, she said. It would be months before Asa met even his grandmother, and months more before he met another child.

Asa spent nearly every minute of his first year with his parents. He got extra attention, but that isolation, and attention, had its effects.

"His speech was delayed," Schneider said. "We were really attentive to his needs, so he didn't need to speak."

At 1, Asa started attending a child care center, and now, at 5, "he's caught up, if not ahead." Still, Schneider worries. While Asa learned to socialize with other kids, he still prefers adult company.

"We wonder how much isolation so early in life has impacted his sense of self," she said.

In coming weeks, Asa and about 60,000 other children born around the 2020 COVID shutdown in Massachusetts are starting kindergarten, marking a shift from those whose childhoods were shaped by lockdowns to those with no memory of them. Across the country, more than 3.6 million children entered the world at the height of the pandemic

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Trepidation as campuses return to life

Cautious steps under Trump's reproachful eye

By Brooke Hauser, Diti Kohli, and Claire Thornton
GLOBE STAFF

History professor Samuel J. Redman ordinarily likes to keep his students at the University of Massachusetts Amherst entertained by riffing on subjects guaranteed to grab their attention, such as the history of drag performance.

But with a new semester dawning on campuses under the reproachful eye of the Trump administration, Redman is thinking twice about going off script, especially if his lectures will be recorded. Improvising, he said, "greatly enhances the potential for a slip-up or a misstatement or saying something that you haven't fully thought out," and he worries it could end up in the hands of people looking to take advantage of the current political climate to harass college professors.

"There's a whole cottage industry of websites doing professor watch lists," said Redman, who is the director of the Public History program on the Amherst campus. "I don't think it is at all outlandish to think that we are being watched and monitored."

If the past year has proven anything, it's that no college truly exists in a bubble, even if a campus can feel that way — especially as students

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DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Daia Jade Johnson (center), a sophomore at Emerson College, assisted another student during move-in day last week.

'HOW DO YOU PROTECT A PLACE LIKE THIS?'

Staffing, funding cuts trouble summer vibe at Acadia park



The Trump administration cut year-round national parks staff by an estimated

24%

Park advocates estimate roughly

100 of the 260

full-time and seasonal positions at Acadia are vacant this year.

SOURCE: National Parks Conservation Association



PHOTOS BY HEATHER DIEHL FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

From top: Jamie and Jessa Montessa hiked along the top of Cadillac Mountain. The sunrise was seen along the Bar Harbor Shore Path. Kayak guide Brooke Yanaga led a group out onto the water in Bar Harbor.

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

BAR HARBOR, Maine — The first bus making the 90-minute loop through Acadia National Park rumbled out of Halls Cove Visitor Center at 9 a.m. on a recent sun-splashed Saturday, packed as full as a shuttle at Disneyworld during spring break.

Hordes of visitors flocked to Acadia this summer for its cool Downeast Maine weather, pastel sunrise vistas atop Cadillac Mountain, extensive network of historic carriage roads for hiking or biking, and miles of Instagram-worthy coastline. On Aug. 23, Ralph Hohmann, 78, and his wife, Barbara, 77, from Long Valley, N.J., were among them, hiking poles in hand, two young granddaughters in tow, on at least their fourth visit to the park over the years.

The morning couldn't have been more postcard perfect.

On the surface, things looked normal at Acadia this summer. And that's exactly the image the Trump administration sought to project here and at other national parks despite cutting year-round staff by an estimated 24 percent across the country and proposing to slash next year's budget by about \$1 billion. Park advocates estimate roughly 100 of the 260 full-time and seasonal positions at Acadia are vacant.

Still, many park visitors are aware of

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Minor charges, aggressive tactics mark D.C. crackdown

Crime rate falling, but some residents fear indiscriminate stops

By Nicholas Bogel-Burroughs, Jeff Adelson, Campbell Robertson, and Bernard Mokam
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — Juan Carlos Dela Torre had already experienced one run-in with one of the roving crews of federal law enforcement agents who descended on Washington, D.C., this month. Then came another last Friday night.

He was standing on the sidewalk smoking a joint, which the officers grabbed as evidence of "consuming marijuana in a public space," a misdemeanor in the district. The officers took him to a local police station, searched him, and, they said, found a small amount of the

stimulant MDMA. He was sent to jail.

"I've never seen this much police presence in my whole life," said Dela Torre, 37, a massage therapist who has lived in Washington since 1994. "You guys are worried about some guy smoking a joint on the corner on a Friday night?"

President Trump declared that crime in Washington was "out of control" earlier this month and said he would use the power of the federal government to "rescue our nation's capital from crime, bloodshed, bedlam, and squalor — and worse."

But a review by The New York Times of about a thousand arrests that were made during the first two weeks of the federal law enforcement surge suggests that the operation has been more of a sprawling dragnet than a targeted crime-fighting operation.

Records show that officers from some

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'Chapel Bill': UNC savors the Belichick boom effect

By Ben Volin
GLOBE STAFF

CHAPEL HILL, N.C. — Details are murky, but local legend is that former Florida State football coach Bobby Bowden was the first to label the University of North Carolina a "sleeping giant," in the 1980s or early 1990s.

The phrase has since become a punchline for UNC, which hasn't won an ACC football title since 1980, let alone compete for a national championship.

"That's what Duke and N.C. State fans mock Carolina with," said Adam Smith, a reporter for the website Inside Carolina. "'Oh yeah, they're a sleeping giant — haven't woke up yet!'"

Rise and shine, UNC. It's finally your moment.

For the first time in, maybe, ever, the UNC football season isn't just something to pass the time until basketball season.

There's a reason that annual giving to the Rams Club reached an all-time high in 2024-25. Why UNC's season tickets sold out by May. Why Hulu has invested in a season-

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